

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

RESERVING JUDGEMENT

The political tug of war between Union minister **Anupriya Patel** and Uttar Pradesh CM **Yogi Adityanath** shows no signs of a thaw. The latest run-in has been over the controversial Nazul Properties Bill, which, among other things, allows the state to reclaim public land leased to private individuals after the tenure ends. The Apna Dal (S) chief waded into the brouhaha, saying it was "anti-people". Last month, she accused the Yogi regime of "unreserving" seats meant for the SCs, STs and OBCs during a recruitment drive. She has also called for a caste census—a key poll issue for the Opposition—which insiders say is a bid to spruce up her fading image among her Kurmi community. Yogi's camp believes Patel wouldn't be so brazen if she didn't have the backing of "higher powers". As for the CM's response, it's the silent yogi treatment, for now.

Let the Games Begin



Gujarat's ministers and officials seem to be taking the prospect of hosting the 2036 Summer Olympics quite seriously. Culture and sports minister **Harsh Sanghavi** is heading to Paris to take in the infrastructure at the ongoing Olympics there, while a delegation headed by Ashwini Kumar, state principal secretary, sports, has been camping in the French capital since the event kicked off. Talks of a collaboration also figured in Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel's meeting with French ambassador Thierry Mathou in July.

Legislative Lament

After the clobbering his YSRCP took in the Andhra Pradesh assembly election, party chief **Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy** would have been excused if he felt a bit sorry for the 11 MLAs (including himself) they have in the 175-seat House. But no, Jagan has been aggressively pursuing the leader of the Opposition (LoP) post, reasoning with assembly speaker Ayyanna Patrudu and, when that failed, dragging the issue to the high court, only to get another thumbs down. Jagan says without LoP status, the YSRCP's voice in the assembly is as good as mute. His only solace: the 30 MLCs his party has in the 58-member legislative council.



ANI

–Kaushik Deka with Prashant Srivastava, Amarnath K. Menon, Jumana Shah, Dhaval S. Kulkarni and Arkamoy Datta Majumdar



Wrong Peg

For most tourists, Goa screams sun, sand and beer. But BJP MLA **Premendra Shet** from Maem sees it differently. Concerned about the "rising alcoholism" among the youth, Shet proposed that prohibition has to be imposed in the state for it to become 'Viksit Goa'. Unfortunately for him, even party colleagues were left a little nonplussed by the idea.

LATE TO THE PARTY

The CPI(M) Bengal unit has come out with a few bombshell revelations. The commissars have finally figured out that calling Lakshmir Bhandar, the state's direct benefit transfer scheme for women, a "dole" hasn't won them brownie points with the poor. And that in their attempt to tar the BJP and Trinamool Congress with the same brush of villainy, they may have actually let the former off the hook. These "groundbreaking" insights, pointed out by countless critics in the past, are part of a recent analysis of their Lok Sabha performance. But with a measly 5.7 per cent of the total vote, has the epiphany come too late?